

E062

Applied Project Management Capstone

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A new project manager is asked to start a warehouse-robotics project. She has a kickoff room booked and a vendor list from a colleague, but no document names her as project manager or authorizes a budget. What should she secure first?

- A. A work breakdown structure.
- B. Quotes from the vendors on the list.
- C. A detailed schedule.
- D. A project charter signed by the sponsor.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

During user acceptance testing, a client says the new portal should also support Spanish. The scope statement lists “English only” under exclusions. The client's IT director is a close friend of the sponsor. What should the project manager do?

- A. Log it as a defect to fix under warranty.
- B. Add it, because the client is always right.
- C. Point to the exclusion and route the request through change control.
- D. Add it quietly to keep the sponsor's friend happy.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

At month 6, a project has PV of \$600,000, EV of \$540,000, and AC of \$500,000. Two team members have been out on leave. How is the project performing?

- A. Behind schedule and under budget.
- B. Ahead of schedule and over budget.
- C. On track, because AC is below PV.
- D. Behind schedule and over budget.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A project is ahead of schedule but over budget. Which pair of indices fits?

- A.** SPI 1.12, CPI 0.91
- B.** SPI 0.91, CPI 1.12
- C.** SPI 1.12, CPI 1.05
- D.** SV -\$20,000, CV +\$15,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

Activity K is not on the critical path and has 4 days of total float. K's supplier is the same one used on the last project. K slips 6 days. What happens to the project finish date?

- A.** It moves 6 days later.
- B.** It moves 2 days later.
- C.** It does not change, because K is not critical.
- D.** It moves 10 days later.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

The project finish date moved out by 3 days after Activity L slipped 8 days. How much total float did L have?

- A.** 0 days
- B.** 5 days
- C.** 11 days
- D.** 8 days

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A risk register lists “key developer may resign” with a planned response of cross-training. The project manager is listed as owner of all 40 risks. The team tracks risks in a shared spreadsheet with color-coding. What change best supports monitoring?

- A.** Assign each risk an owner close to it who watches triggers and carries out the response.
- B.** Add more colors to the spreadsheet.
- C.** Permanently delete every low-rated risk.
- D.** Keep the PM as owner of all risks for clear accountability.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A facilities manager who controls access to the server room was never involved in the data-center project and just heard about it in a hallway conversation. She has worked at the company for 20 years. She is now blocking access. What should the project manager do first?

- A. Email her the full project plan and proceed.
- B. Escalate to the sponsor to force access.
- C. Meet with her to understand her concerns and engage her, then update the stakeholder register and plan.
- D. Wait, since blockers always come around.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

The team has finished every deliverable for a hospital scheduling system. The celebration dinner is booked for Friday at a steakhouse. The client has not yet signed formal acceptance. What must happen before administrative closure?

- A. Hold the celebration dinner first.
- B. Obtain the client's formal acceptance of the deliverables.
- C. Release the team and archive files right away.
- D. Nothing; finished deliverables count as accepted.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

When should lessons learned be captured on a project?

- A. Only at the very end of the project.
- B. Only after something goes wrong.
- C. Only at kickoff, from earlier projects.
- D. Throughout the project, then finalized at closing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A software team spends \$20,000 on code reviews and training, \$30,000 on testing, and \$90,000 fixing defects customers find after release. The team lead owns a vintage sports car. Which change would most likely lower total cost of quality?

- A. Cut prevention spending to save \$20,000.
- B. Quality cost always rises when prevention spending rises.
- C. Hire more post-release support staff.
- D. Invest more in prevention to reduce external failure costs.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A project's quality costs are: prevention \$15,000, appraisal \$25,000, internal failure \$40,000, and external failure \$60,000. What is the cost of nonconformance?

- A. \$40,000
- B. \$60,000
- C. \$100,000
- D. \$140,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A new project manager is asked to start a warehouse-robotics project. She has ~~a kickoff room booked and a vendor list from a colleague~~, but no document names her as project manager or authorizes a budget. What should she secure first?

Target word: first step **Decides:** No authorization exists yet.

A	Adjacent category	A planning output that comes after authorization.
B	Camouflage	The vendor list does not authorize spending.
C	Inverted operation	Planning before authorization reverses the order.
D	Correct	The charter authorizes the project and the PM's use of resources.

2. Answer C Concept 2

During user acceptance testing, a client says the new portal should also support Spanish. The scope statement lists "English only" under exclusions. ~~The client's IT director is a close friend of the sponsor.~~ What should the project manager do?

Target word: handling an excluded request **Decides:** Spanish is an explicit exclusion.

A	Confusion set	A defect fails a requirement; this was never a requirement.
B	Absolute language	Client wishes still go through change control.
C	Correct	Out-of-scope work needs an approved change.
D	Camouflage	Relationships do not bypass change control.

3. Answer A Concept 3

At month 6, a project has PV of \$600,000, EV of \$540,000, and AC of \$500,000. ~~Two team members have been out on leave.~~ How is the project performing?

Target word: schedule and cost status **Decides:** SPI = 0.90; CPI = 1.08.

A	Correct	$SPI = 540/600 = 0.90$; $CPI = 540/500 = 1.08$.
B	Inverted operation	Reverses both readings.
C	Adjacent category	AC vs. PV is not a valid performance measure.
D	Confusion set	Reads EV below PV as a cost problem too; cost compares EV with AC.

4. Answer A Concept 3 • transfer

A project is ahead of schedule but over budget. Which pair of indices fits?

Target word: work backward from status to indices **Decides:** Ahead: SPI above 1; over budget: CPI below 1.

A	Correct	$SPI > 1$ is ahead; $CPI < 1$ is over budget.
B	Inverted operation	Swaps the two readings.
C	Adjacent category	Both favorable: ahead and under budget.
D	Confusion set	Behind schedule and under budget.

5. Answer B Concept 4

Activity K is not on the critical path and has 4 days of total float. ~~K's supplier is the same one used on the last project.~~ K slips 6 days. What happens to the project finish date?

Target word: project delay **Decides:** Slip exceeds float by 2 days.

A	Dropped element	Ignores the float.
B	Correct	$6 - 4 = 2$ days beyond float.
C	Adjacent category	A non-critical activity becomes critical once its slip exceeds float.
D	Inverted operation	Adds float instead of subtracting it.

6. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

The project finish date moved out by 3 days after Activity L slipped 8 days. How much total float did L have?

Target word: solve for float **Decides:** Float = slip – project delay.

A	Adjacent category	With zero float, the project would have moved 8 days.
B	Correct	$8 - 3 = 5$.
C	Inverted operation	Adds instead of subtracting.
D	Wrong stem number	That is the slip.

7. Answer A Concept 5

A risk register lists “key developer may resign” with a planned response of cross-training. The project manager is listed as owner of all 40 risks. ~~The team tracks risks in a shared spreadsheet with color coding.~~ What change best supports monitoring?

Target word: improve risk monitoring **Decides:** One person owns every risk.

A	Correct	Distributed ownership catches triggers early.
B	Camouflage	Formatting does not create ownership.
C	Absolute language	Low risks can grow; they stay on a watch list.
D	Confusion set	Confuses overall accountability with risk ownership.

8. Answer C Concept 6

A facilities manager who controls access to the server room was never involved in the data-center project and just heard about it in a hallway conversation. ~~She has worked at the company for 20 years.~~ She is now blocking access. What should the project manager do first?

Target word: first step with a resisting stakeholder **Decides:** She was overlooked and has concerns.

A	Dropped element	One-way push drops the engagement she needs.
B	Adjacent category	Escalation is a later step, and forcing hurts the relationship.
C	Correct	Direct engagement comes before escalation.
D	Absolute language	Waiting leaves the block in place.

9. Answer B Concept 7

The team has finished every deliverable for a hospital scheduling system. ~~The celebration dinner is booked for Friday at a steakhouse.~~ The client has not yet signed formal acceptance. What must happen before administrative closure?

Target word: closing prerequisite **Decides:** No formal acceptance yet.

A	Camouflage	The dinner is not a closing requirement.
B	Correct	Acceptance precedes closure.
C	Dropped element	Skips acceptance and lessons learned.
D	Confusion set	Completion is not acceptance.

10. Answer D Concept 7 • transfer

When should lessons learned be captured on a project?

Target word: timing of lessons learned **Decides:** Captured throughout, finalized at close.

A	Absolute language	Waiting loses details and prevents mid-project use.
B	Adjacent category	Successes are lessons too.
C	Inverted operation	Reviewing old lessons is not capturing new ones.
D	Correct	Ongoing capture keeps details fresh.

11. Answer D Concept 8

A software team spends \$20,000 on code reviews and training, \$30,000 on testing, and \$90,000 fixing defects customers find after release. ~~The team lead owns a vintage sports car.~~ Which change would most likely lower total cost of quality?

Target word: lower total cost of quality **Decides:** External failure is the largest cost.

A	Inverted operation	Fewer prevention dollars mean more failures.
B	Absolute language	Prevention usually lowers total quality cost.
C	Adjacent category	Handles failures rather than preventing them.
D	Correct	Prevention costs less than fixing defects after release.

12. Answer C Concept 8 • transfer

A project's quality costs are: prevention \$15,000, appraisal \$25,000, internal failure \$40,000, and external failure \$60,000. What is the cost of nonconformance?

Target word: cost of nonconformance **Decides:** Nonconformance = internal + external failure.

A	Inverted operation	Prevention + appraisal is the cost of conformance.
B	Dropped element	Leaves out internal failure.
C	Correct	$\$40,000 + \$60,000 = \$100,000$.
D	Confusion set	Total cost of quality, not nonconformance.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Project charter	The charter formally authorizes the project, names the project manager, and gives authority to use resources; it comes before detailed planning.	Starting planning or vendor work before authorization.	Work starting with no document naming the PM or budget.
2	Scope exclusions and scope creep	Items listed as exclusions are out of scope; adding them requires a change request.	Adding requested work informally or calling it a defect.	A late request for something the scope statement excludes.
3	Reading CPI and SPI together	$SPI = EV / PV$ (schedule) and $CPI = EV / AC$ (cost); each is read separately against 1.0.	Comparing AC with PV to judge cost.	PV, EV, and AC all given.
4	Float and project delay	A slip beyond an activity's total float delays the project by the excess.	Assuming non-critical slips never matter, or the full slip always passes through.	An activity's float and the size of its slip.
5	Risk ownership	Each risk has an owner close to it who watches triggers and carries out the response; the PM stays accountable overall.	Making the PM the owner of every risk.	A risk register with one default owner.
6	Engaging a blocking stakeholder	An overlooked stakeholder is engaged directly to understand concerns before escalating; then the register and plan are updated.	Escalating or pushing documents first.	A stakeholder who learned of the project late and is resisting.
7	Closing and lessons learned	Formal acceptance comes before administrative closure; lessons learned are captured throughout and finalized at close.	Treating finished deliverables as accepted, or saving lessons for the very end.	Work complete but no sign-off.
8	Cost of quality	Conformance costs (prevention, appraisal) usually cost less than nonconformance costs (internal and external failure); prevention lowers total cost of quality.	Cutting prevention to save money.	Prevention, appraisal, and failure costs listed.

Course scope (public description): In the capstone experience, learners will immerse themselves in a real-world project context, where they will have the opportunity to showcase their project management knowledge, skills, and abilities in a dynamic and practical setting. Through hands-on experiences and projects, learners will demonstrate their ability to navigate complex project challenges, apply strategic thinking, and deliver successful project outcomes. This culminating experience will allow learners to integrate theory with practice, showcasing their growth, creativity, and readiness to excel as project management professionals in diverse and challenging environments.